

father will hear about this.” (This wasn’t what he was like in real life at all, but his button-nose and deep-set eyes made him seem adorably snobbish.)

Because of our different backgrounds, there were severe money blindspots between us. He didn’t take out loans for college. His family owned multiple properties. But if the saying goes that “rich people have the luxury of never having to think about money,” then he was, in practice, not that. He thought about money a lot. He saved money. He had investments. He knew to negotiate his salary. This was not how I thought about money, and I thought about money a lot too.

He’d left a cushy job in finance to become a writer, but not without careful consideration. He was able to take that career risk by saving A LOT beforehand. I’d come out to LA with next to nothing, no plan, and a job that didn’t pay well, and I was living in a small apartment with someone sleeping in the living room to offset the price of our rent. He, meanwhile, had moved into a house with three other roommates. He could have afforded to live alone but decided instead to save that money. I couldn’t understand his thinking. My philosophy was once you have the money, you spend the money immediately to make your life more comfortable. Why squirrel it away while you live a less-than-ideal life?

When I visited his family’s winter home, I was shocked to learn it was empty most of the year. Joking with his parents (but also semiserious), I asked if I could live there rent free. While we were together, he gifted me \$3,000, no strings attached, to help get me out of a hole I’d dug for myself because of car repairs. I asked if I ever had to pay it back, and he said he honestly would not miss the money. To his credit, after we split up, he never tried to get that money back. He really did not need it.

During our relationship, he felt he had to rescue me: the same pressure I’d felt with the people I dated who were making less than me. And in the end, that same stress contributed to our breakup, just the other way around.



Though it can be easier to date someone who has a similar money situation or at least a similar script, I don’t mean to imply that it’s impossible to date outside